



Facebook Dating Feature

Facebook is testing its dating feature in Columbia. If it goes well then the feature will soon be rolled out to more countries. <https://digit.in/oct18-28-1>



Oneplus Smart TV

Oneplus is developing its own smart TV and is running a contest to give it a name. <https://digit.in/oct18-28-2>

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n 2010, to tackle the problem of unsolicited commercial communications (UCC), or spam calls and messages, the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India established the “Do not disturb” registry. Over 23 crore subscribers are registered on this database. The purpose of the registry was to give subscribers the choice to opt out of receiving blind calls for commercial purposes. This did not really tackle the problem, as marketers

track spam callers. On August 27, 2018, Tech Mahindra and Microsoft announced a collaboration to build a blockchain based solution in line with the draft regulations of TRAI. A series of sessions were conducted with the authorities and the various stakeholders, or the telecom operators to design the solution. The solution is built on the Microsoft Azure platform.

Through the system, the telecom operators can keep track of preference registration, consent, dynamic preferences, stakeholder onboarding,

also be used to track and prevent fraud calls. Rajesh Dhuddu, Global Practice Leader, Blockchain at Tech Mahindra, said, “This Distributed Ledger Technology (DLT)-based solution will enable enterprises to stop financial frauds and perpetration of misleading financial information by unregistered telecom marketers who rampantly use the SMS service of Telcos”.

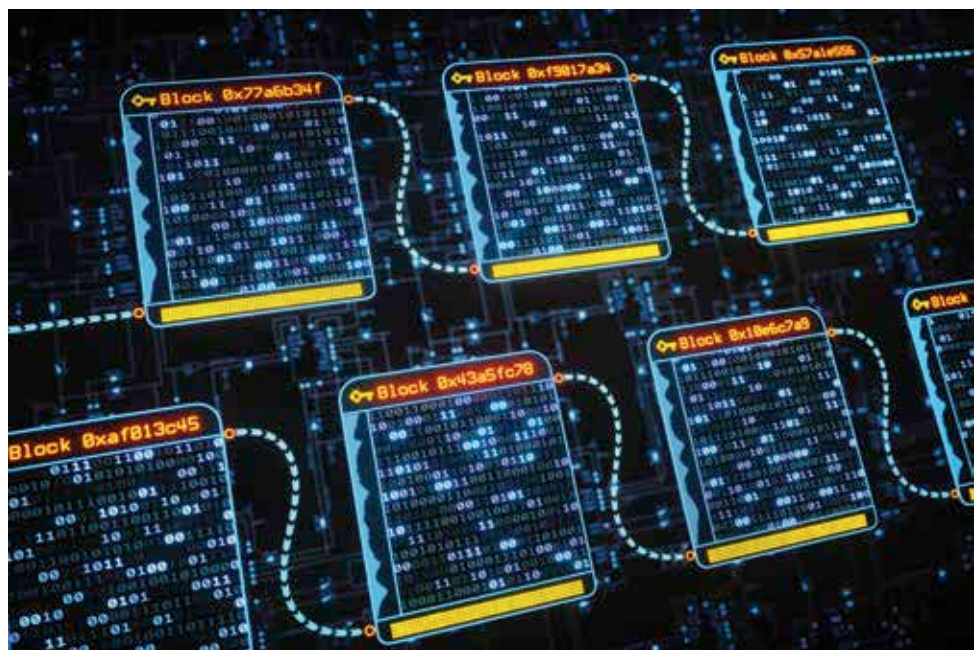
We reached out to Dr. Pandurang Kamat, the Chief Technologist & Associate CTO, Persistent Systems to better understand the implementation.

Blockchain

This is how TRAI intends to use blockchain to tackle the problem of spam calls and messages.

Aditya Madanapalle | aditya@digit.in

found unethical ways of obtaining the consent of users, or used unregistered telemarketers to make the calls. At the same time, the number of fraud related calls also increased. In September 2017, TRAI initiated a public consultation on the feasibility of using blockchain to tackle the problem, and register the consent of the users. This was followed up with an open house discussion in December 2017. Following the responses to the consultation, on 29th of May, 2018, TRAI notified draft regulations for using distributed ledger technologies, or blockchain to tackle the problem. A part of the implementation includes using AI to identify and



complaint registration and tracking. To the end user, this means more granular options regarding spam calls, depending on their preferences. Additionally, it also becomes easier to complain and track the response in case they receive any unwanted communications. The same system will

Our first question was how exactly the blockchain would be implemented. “Blockchain will be used to record user consent for receiving calls/sms from a particular business, keep a record of any changes the user makes to this consent and the confirmation of communication to the user confirming